PRODUCT DECISION MEMO / ECOMMERCE GROWTH

Simplified Checkout Experiment

TO	FROM	DATE	
Ecommerce Product Manager	Product Analytics	31 July 2026	PROVISIONAL GO TO EXPERIMENT

DECISION

Advance a simplified checkout into a user-randomized A/B test.

Do not claim that the current checkout causes abandonment. Launch only after sticky exposure logging, a validated 24-hour purchase window, guardrails, current user throughput, and the minimum worthwhile effect are approved.

360,129	5,187	48.02%	$306,678
VALID SESSIONS	CHECKOUT SESSIONS	CHECKOUT COMPLETION PROXY	CANONICAL GROSS REVENUE

01 / WHY THIS DECISION

Observed opportunity and measurement correction

OBSERVED OPPORTUNITY

Largest behavioral loss. Product view to cart retains 18.67%; 62,640 sessions are lost before cart.

Checkout is measurable. The governed population contains 5,187 starts and 2,491 clean purchases.

Broader scenario. A +0.50 pp checkout lift equals 25.9 orders and $1,793, versus 21.46 orders and $1,483.56 for the top single PDP.

No mobile deficit. Mobile purchase conversion is 1.15% versus 1.10% on Desktop; the difference interval includes zero.

MEASUREMENT CORRECTION

The 941 strict-path gaps are not 941 abandonments.

100% have shipping at or before the governed checkout start.

100% have payment after checkout and before purchase.

0 lack shipping everywhere in the session.

92.75% of checkout sessions repeat begin_checkout.

Implication: use a dedicated sticky exposure event and clean purchase within 24 hours as the primary outcome.

02 / ALTERNATIVES

What was considered and why it ranks lower

OPTION	EVIDENCE	DECISION
Simplify checkout	+0.50 pp scenario: 25.9 orders and $1,793; direct exposure and outcome can be instrumented.	**Advance to test**
Optimize top PDP	Super G Unisex Joggers: 21.46-order scenario; result is robust in rank but benchmark-sensitive and non-additive.	**Retain as secondary**
Mobile-only redesign	Mobile purchase conversion is not below Desktop; the 95% difference interval includes zero.	**Deprioritize**
Channel targeting	70.13% of sessions sit in weak-quality attribution buckets.	**Not decision-grade**

Confidence: sufficient to test, insufficient to ship. All 43 core and analysis-layer reconciliations passed; historical segment differences remain descriptive.

PRODUCT DECISION MEMO / IMPLEMENTATION CONTRACT

Experiment contract and launch gates

The design is reproducible, but the experiment is not launch-ready until assignment, outcomes, guardrails, and current throughput are validated at the user level.

03 / EXPERIMENT DESIGN

Locked planning rules

ELEMENT	LOCKED RULE
Control	Current checkout.
Treatment	One streamlined page combining shipping and payment; remove nonessential optional fields while preserving price, shipping, tax, order summary, accessibility, and trust disclosures.
Randomization	Sticky 50/50 assignment by pseudonymous user at first eligible checkout. Repeated checkout starts must not re-randomize.
Primary outcome	Clean purchase within 24 hours of first eligible exposure; intention-to-treat analysis.
Primary estimand	Treatment minus Control conversion in percentage points, with a 95% Newcombe interval and pooled two-proportion z-test.
Secondary	Gross purchase revenue per eligible assigned user.
Guardrails	Payment-error rate, refund or cancellation rate, and checkout completion time after telemetry validation.

04 / SAMPLE AND FEASIBILITY

The approved MDE determines whether the test is practical

48.02%	+5.00 pp	1,648	3,296	8.35 wk
HISTORICAL BASELINE PROXY	PROVISIONAL MDE	BUFFERED PER ARM	BUFFERED TOTAL	SESSION-VOLUME PROXY

+0.50 pp 25.9 orders / $1,793	**+2.00 pp** 103.7 orders / $7,172	**+5.00 pp** 259.4 orders / $17,930	**Important:** scenarios are not forecasts. The 8.35-week duration is optimistic until current unique-user throughput and the 24-hour baseline are measured.

05 / DECISION RULES

A positive p-value alone is not a shipping rule

1	**Integrity first.** Run the 50/50 sample-ratio-mismatch check before reading outcomes. Stop and investigate if SRM $p < 0.001$.
2	**Effect threshold.** Require a positive primary interval and a point estimate that meets the stakeholder-approved minimum worthwhile effect.
3	**Guardrails.** Payment errors, refunds or cancellations, and completion time must remain within approved non-inferiority margins.
4	**Stopping discipline.** Stop at the buffered sample only at the end of a full week. Do not peek, change the MDE, or promote subgroup findings after outcomes are visible.

06 / LAUNCH GATES

Owners and evidence required before traffic is exposed

OWNER	REQUIRED BEFORE LAUNCH
Analytics	Validate sticky exposure, 24-hour clean-purchase attribution, current unique eligible users per day, the user-level baseline, and SRM monitoring.
Engineering	Prevent re-randomization and validate payment-error, refund or cancellation, and completion-time telemetry.
Payments + Product	Approve guardrail margins and confirm that +5.00 pp is the smallest effect worth shipping.
Product + Design	Freeze the treatment and preserve disclosure, accessibility, price transparency, and user trust.

SIMULATION DISCLOSURE

The seeded notebook result (+6.80 pp; 95% CI +3.39 to +10.19 pp; $p = 0.00009$) is synthetic demonstration output. It provides no evidence about a real checkout treatment.

FINAL RECOMMENDATION

Validate instrumentation and obtain sign-off, then run the user-randomized test. Do not ship from historical analysis or the seeded simulation.

Evidence base: Google GA4 public ecommerce sample, 2020-11-01 through 2021-01-31; aggregate run 20260731T052813Z; 43 of 43 hard checks passed. Open the public interactive dashboard.